

1998-84

DOCUMENTATION OF RARE BIRD SIGHTING

Species: Anna's Hummingbird

Calyppte anna

Date(s): May 18, 1998

Time seen: 7:30-9 am (3 times); 5 pm (once)

June 7 1998

5:00-6:30 pm

PHOTO

Present May 17-June 7+

Locality: Franktown, Douglas County; home of Kathy and Howard Dressel

Latilong: 39104 (12)

Optical equipment: eyes, 8x42 binocs

Photographs attempted, and some enclosed.

nid 6-19-98 ✓

Number of birds seen: One

Sex: Male Plumage: Adult

Light conditions: Fair to excellent

Distance from bird: 8-25 feet

Weather at time of observation: clear, warm

Describe habitat: Feeder at a home surrounded by Ponderosa pines

Describe behavior: First observation, May 18: Came into feeder, stayed 5-10 seconds, then left. Homeowner says that it drove off a Broad-tailed yesterday evening (May 17).

June 7: Bird came to feeder several times, briefly; then it perched in two different ponderosas located adjacent to the deck and hummingbird feeder, where we observed him for 15 minutes. He occasionally flicked out his tongue, as if trying to catch passing insects. Sometimes he chased off the Broad-tailed males, sometimes not, but he did not go after the female broad-tails.

Field marks observed: size, color, pattern, shape, bill, etc.:

May 18: Roughly the same size as a Broad-tailed Hummingbird.

Forehead and throat same vivid red color, seemingly a slightly different shade from Broad-tailed.

Lower edges of gorget flare back across back of neck, moreso than Broad-tailed.

Greenish back, pale breast.

June 7: As it perched in the two pines we had excellent views. The throat and forehead reflected a wide variety of colors, depending on the light angle. The colors ranged from bird book rose/purple to hot pink, crimson red, tangerine, and yellow, on both throat and crown.

Bird's call or song: The bird's wings make a loud hum.

The bird chips, distinguishable from that made by female Broad-tails by having a more staccato or sharper sound. He sometimes chips at the feeder, and sometimes when he sits on the perch or chases other hummingbirds.

Field marks not seen: All field marks noticed except bill length compared with Broad-tailed (the only other species coming to the feeder).

Similar species: The iridescent, usually red, forehead rules out all other male hummingbirds.

Broad-tailed: Green forehead, wing trill,

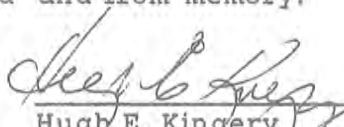
Black-chinned: Green forehead, different throat, small size.

Prior experience: Hugh: none since a California sojourn 30 years ago.

Urling, none. We've seen lots of the typical Colorado hummingbirds.

Description from: Notes taken in field and from memory.

Also observed by Karen Metz.



Hugh E. Kingery



Urling C. Kingery

PO Box 584, Franktown CO 80116

DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAIR BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

1998-84

Species: ANNA'S HUMMINGBIRD
(Vernacular name)

Calypte anna
(Scientific name)

ACCEPTED (7-0)
photo)

mid 8-20-98 ✓

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): MAY 16 - JUNE 6, 1998 Time Bird Seen: 6:15AM to 8:30PM

Locality: FRANKTOWN, CO DOUGLAS COUNTY

Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: 8x42 BINOCULARS & 8x22 BINOCULARS

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used:

CROWN

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: MALE Plumage: RED FOREHEAD & THROAT

Light conditions: VARIED

Distance from bird, and how measured: 6-8'

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

FED AT A HUMMINGBIRD NECTAR FEEDER EVERY DAY FOR OVER 3 WEEKS;
SAT IN A NEARBY PONDEROSA PINE TREE & GUARDED THE FEEDER
FROM BROAD-TAILED HUMMINGBIRDS

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

PONDEROSA PINE FOREST

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

HUGH & URLINE KINGERY } FRANKTOWN, CO
KEN & KAREN METZ }

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to ~~field marks~~ ~~enough.~~) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

THE BIRD WAS A MALE HUMMINGBIRD. IT HAD A RED (ROSE-RED) GORGET, FOREHEAD & CROWN. THE RED ON THE GORGET ALSO EXTENDED ONTO THE SIDES OF THE NECK. THE BACK & SIDES WERE GREEN.

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

CHIPPING FROM PERCH & IN FLIGHT

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

BROAD-TAILED HUMMINGBIRD - THIS BIRD DID NOT MAKE THE TRILLING SOUND IN FLIGHT. THIS BIRD HAD RED ON ITS FOREHEAD & CROWN.

Prior experience with this and similar species:

SEEN ANNAIS HUMMINGBIRDS IN CALIFORNIA WHILE VISITING AUNT & UNCLE. WATCHED & FED HUMMINGBIRDS IN GOLDEN FOR 9 SUMMER

This report was written from notes made during ___ after ___ observation; from memory ☒

NAME (print): HOWARD & KATHY DRESSSEL

Mailing address: 9805 DEERFIELD ROAD, FRANKTOWN, CO 80116

Signature: Kathryn M. Dressel

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
c/o Curator - Dept. of Zoological Collections
Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205

